

¿Verdad o Mentira? — Truth or Lie?

GRADES 5-8

30 MINUTES

SPANISH

Students learn vocabulary for truth, lies, and visual deception while exploring how optical illusions connect to the theme of appearances vs. reality. Designed for novice-low to novice-mid learners with heritage speaker support.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Students will acquire vocabulary related to truth/deception (**verdad, mentira, real, falso, creer, ver**), practice expressing opinions using "**Creo que...**" and "**Pienso que...**", and connect language learning to critical thinking about visual media.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

ACTFL: Interpersonal Communication (novice-mid), Presentational Communication (novice-mid)

TEKS §114.22: Engage in conversations using simple phrases and sentences.

MATERIALS NEEDED

- Spirit photography example from Mini Museum
- Vocabulary cards or projected word list
- Student handouts (three levels available)
- **Mini Museum Perception Lab:** minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving/illusions

KEY VOCABULARY

la verdad — the truth

la mentira — the lie

real — real

falso/falsa — false/fake

verdadero/a — true

creer — to believe

ver — to see

engañar — to trick/deceive

los ojos — the eyes

la foto(grafía) — the photo

SENTENCE FRAMES (FOR ALL LEVELS)

Creo que es... — I believe it is...

Pienso que es... — I think it is...

¿Es verdad o mentira? — Is it truth or lie?

Mis ojos ven... — My eyes see...

La foto es real/falsa. — The photo is real/fake.

LESSON PLAN

Hook: ¿Qué ves? — What do you see? (5 minutes)

Display an optical illusion. Point to your eyes.

"¿Qué ven tus ojos?" (What do your eyes see?) — Have students call out what they see. Then reveal the illusion. **"¡Tus ojos te engañan!"** (Your eyes trick you!)

Introduce key vocabulary: **ver, los ojos, engañar, la verdad, la mentira**. Use gestures and visuals.

Lesson Plan (continued)

Vocabulary Introduction (8 minutes)

Present vocabulary with Total Physical Response (TPR) and comprehensible input:

- **Verdad** — thumbs up, nod head
- **Mentira** — thumbs down, shake head
- **Real** — touch something solid
- **Falso** — wave hand like "no"
- **Creer** — hand on heart

Quick practice: Show images, students respond "**¡Verdad!**" or "**¡Mentira!**"

Mini Museum Connection: La Fotografía de Espíritus (10 minutes)

Show spirit photography example.

"En 1860, un fotógrafo dijo: 'Puedo fotografiar fantasmas.' Muchas personas creyeron. ¿Es verdad o mentira?" (In 1860, a photographer said: 'I can photograph ghosts.' Many people believed. Is it truth or lie?)

Partner practice: Students discuss using sentence frames: "**Creo que es mentira porque...**" (I believe it's a lie because...). Heritage speakers can help partners with vocabulary.

Activity: ¿Verdad o Mentira? Game (5 minutes)

Show 4-5 images (mix of real and manipulated). Students hold up **VERDAD** or **MENTIRA** cards. After each: "**¿Por qué crees eso?**" (Why do you believe that?) — Students respond using sentence frames.

Closing: Reflection (2 minutes)

"No todo lo que vemos es verdad. Debemos pensar antes de creer." (Not everything we see is truth. We should think before believing.)

Exit ticket: Students write one sentence using new vocabulary.

Mini Museum Connection

Option 1 — Visit: Students describe artifacts using Spanish: "**Veo una foto. Creo que es falsa.**"

Option 2 — Virtual: minimuseumproject.com/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

DIFFERENTIATION NOTES

- **Novice learners:** Focus on single words and simple sentence frames; use visuals heavily
- **Heritage speakers:** Encourage expanded responses, help peers, write more complex sentences
- **All levels:** Accept code-switching; vocabulary is the goal, not perfect grammar

ASSESSMENT

Formative: Observe vocabulary use during game and partner work.

Exit ticket: Write one sentence: "**Creo que _____ es verdad/mentira porque _____.**"